

Halcyon Duskmere

Character Dossier

Charming and evasive herbalist of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Halcyon Duskmere is a herbalist living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Halcyon is 71 years old, originally from Anselm, and is known around the east rampart as charming and evasive. In conversation Halcyon mutters prices and measurements while thinking.

Background

Halcyon arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 19 years ago after leaving Anselm under circumstances Halcyon describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Halcyon works as a herbalist near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Halcyon learned the trade from Anouk Stillwater, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Halcyon's life is with Umberto Lindqvist, over a matter neither will explain. The person Halcyon trusts most is Winifred Zimmerling.

Current goal: to map every path through the east rampart. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: charming and evasive.

Speech pattern: Halcyon mutters prices and measurements while thinking.

Tells: when lying, Halcyon mentions Biscuit the lizard for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Halcyon Duskmere
Role	herbalist
Home	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
Hometown	Anselm
Age	71
Favourite dish	charred pickled plums
Pet	Biscuit, a lizard
Lucky number	785

<i>Workshop password</i>	umber-quill
<i>Mentor</i>	Anouk Stillwater
<i>Rival</i>	Umberto Lindqvist
<i>Closest friend</i>	Winifred Zimmerling

Secret

Halcyon has a sibling nobody in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border knows about, living quietly in Anselm.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Halcyon: I am the herbalist. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Halcyon: Charred pickled plums. Do not tell Umberto I said so.

Visitor: Is Biscuit yours?

Halcyon: Biscuit belongs to nobody. Biscuit tolerates me. Lucky number is 785, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 25

Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. Halcyon closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance.

Entry 2, winter of year 25

The weather turned. Halcyon moved the grain scale indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the rumour of a second well. Halcyon won 12 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Halcyon closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. Jorah came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 3, summer of year 25

Jasper came by asking about the new curfew. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Halcyon closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance.

Entry 4, spring of year 25

Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the mess hall. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Halcyon moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the new curfew. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At the mess hall, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 5, summer of year 25

Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. The weather turned. Halcyon moved the sextant indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the rumour of a second well. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the quartermaster's stores. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Wilhelmina came by asking about the harvest count. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, autumn of year 25

Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Halcyon repaired the oilskin map at the east rampart for Soren, who paid in 4 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note.

Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right.

Entry 7, spring of year 25

A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Halcyon found a clockwork bird half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the signal tower, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. Halcyon spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 16 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short.

Entry 8, spring of year 25

Halcyon was hired to carry a sack of salt from the signal tower to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the signal tower. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Halcyon won 87 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Halcyon was hired to carry a hand bell from the signal tower to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Halcyon repaired the oilskin map at the signal tower for Bram, who paid in 70 iron pennies and a long story about the harvest count.

Entry 9, summer of year 25

The weather turned. Halcyon moved the bundle of letters indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the old tunnels. Halcyon closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. Halcyon closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 10, winter of year 25

Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Halcyon read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Halcyon closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. A dispute over the comet flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 11, spring of year 25

A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Halcyon won 70 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Halcyon repaired the wax seal at the frozen moat for Corvina, who paid in 6 iron pennies and a long story about the tariff on salt. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 12, summer of year 25

A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour

and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the comet flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 13, summer of year 25

A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Halcyon won 43 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 14, autumn of year 25

Halcyon was hired to carry a glass float from the frozen moat to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Halcyon was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the frozen moat to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Halcyon found a sextant half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the harvest count reached the frozen moat. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 15, summer of year 25

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Halcyon won 87 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the quartermaster's stores. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 16, autumn of year 25

Ursula came by asking about the missing shipment. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. Halcyon won 40 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Halcyon spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 41 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short.

Entry 17, autumn of year 25

At the frozen moat, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Halcyon found a spool of wire half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Halcyon won 47 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on charred pickled plums.

Entry 18, spring of year 25

Halcyon was hired to carry a hand bell from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the census flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Halcyon won 63 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Yannick came by asking about the tariff on salt. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Halcyon found a sextant

half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 19, winter of year 25

A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the census flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Halcyon repaired the brass lantern at the quartermaster's stores for Liora, who paid in 65 iron pennies and a long story about the singing at the docks.

Entry 20, spring of year 25

Halcyon found a clockwork bird half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Halcyon spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 48 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short. Halcyon won 72 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on charred pickled plums.

Entry 21, autumn of year 25

Halcyon was hired to carry a tin whistle from the frozen moat to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the frozen moat. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the frozen moat. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 22, autumn of year 25

At the east rampart, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Halcyon repaired the copper pipe at the east rampart for Isadora, who paid in 52 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Halcyon was hired to carry a brass lantern from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Halcyon won 73 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on charred pickled plums.

Entry 23, winter of year 25

Halcyon closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the old tunnels. Halcyon read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 24, winter of year 25

Halcyon was hired to carry a brass lantern from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the east rampart, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. Halcyon won 4 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on charred pickled plums.

Entry 25, summer of year 26

Halcyon repaired the glass float at the mess hall for Sixten, who paid in 64 iron pennies and a long story about who really won the regatta. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. Halcyon closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right.

Entry 26, spring of year 26

Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. Halcyon was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 27, spring of year 26

Halcyon won 50 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 28, autumn of year 26

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. At the mess hall, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real cracked compass from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Halcyon moved the bolt of linen indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the missing shipment.

Entry 29, autumn of year 26

Halcyon spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 19 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short. At the east rampart, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Pilar came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the east rampart, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 30, winter of year 26

A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Halcyon won 50 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Halcyon closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. The weather turned. Halcyon moved the tin whistle indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about who really won the regatta. Halcyon won 76 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on charred pickled plums.

Entry 31, spring of year 26

Kwame came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Halcyon repaired the bolt of linen at the mess hall for Fenwick, who paid in 31 iron pennies and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Halcyon won 70 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Halcyon repaired the bundle of letters at the mess hall for Rosalind, who paid in 15 iron pennies and a long story about the tariff on salt.

Entry 32, winter of year 26

Halcyon won 17 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on charred pickled plums. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the signal tower. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Halcyon closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. At the signal tower, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real hand bell from a fake one by weight alone. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the new curfew. Halcyon read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 33, winter of year 26

A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Halcyon found a bundle of letters half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Halcyon found a coil of rope half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Halcyon for the password to the workshop. Halcyon laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 34, spring of year 26

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. The weather turned. Halcyon moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about who really won the regatta. Halcyon won 41 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on charred pickled plums.

Entry 35, summer of year 26

Halcyon closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. Tallulah came by asking about the census. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Halcyon found a bundle of letters half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 36, summer of year 26

At the quartermaster's stores, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. Halcyon closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Halcyon and Umberto outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the harvest count. Halcyon read it twice, folded it into a square and

used it to level a table.

Entry 37, spring of year 27

At the signal tower, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. Halcyon was hired to carry a signal flag from the signal tower to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Halcyon closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. Halcyon found a oilskin map half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Orsolya came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 38, autumn of year 27

Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. Jorah came by asking about the tax on doors. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the quarantine reached the frozen moat. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 39, autumn of year 27

At the mess hall, Halcyon taught Winifred how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Halcyon was hired to carry a iron kettle from the mess hall to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. Halcyon closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance.

Entry 40, autumn of year 27

Nkechi came by asking about the tax on doors. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right. Halcyon was hired to carry a wax seal from the frozen moat to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right.

Entry 41, winter of year 27

Halcyon was hired to carry a oilskin map from the mess hall to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the mess hall. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Halcyon spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 55 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. Halcyon won 51 iron pennies from Umberto on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on charred pickled plums.

Entry 42, autumn of year 27

The weather turned. Halcyon moved the ledger indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the tariff on salt. Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Nikolai came by asking about the quarantine. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. Halcyon was hired to carry a cracked compass from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 43, autumn of year 27

Anouk visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Halcyon found a wax seal half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the east rampart. Halcyon pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Halcyon moved the grain scale indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the singing at the docks. Halcyon closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance.

Entry 44, autumn of year 27

The weather turned. Halcyon moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Biscuit, and wrote three lines to Anouk about the quarantine. Zora came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Halcyon said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the old tunnels. Halcyon read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Halcyon suspects Winifred and is probably right.

Entry 45, spring of year 27

Halcyon closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Biscuit followed at a distance. Halcyon was hired to carry a oilskin map from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Halcyon found a cracked compass half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.